SENATE PROCLAMATION NO. 304

WHEREAS, The Senate of the State of Texas is pleased to recognize Captain Theresa Claiborne, a pioneering aviator and distinguished military veteran, who is serving as keynote speaker for the First in Flight Luncheon at the Frontiers of Flight Museum in Dallas on October 16, 2026; and

WHEREAS, Theresa Claiborne has earned a lasting place in aviation history as the first Black woman to serve as a pilot and flight instructor in the United States Air Force; she was commissioned in 1981 and completed undergraduate pilot training at Laughlin Air Force Base the following year; during her seven years on active duty, she piloted KC-135 Stratotankers for the Strategic Air Command; and

WHEREAS, Theresa transitioned from active duty but continued to break barriers and sharpen her expertise in the Air Force Reserve, where she served as a flight instructor and commander; she advanced to the rank of lieutenant colonel and retired from the military after 20 years of service and more than 3,000 flight hours; and

WHEREAS, In 1990, Theresa began her career with United Airlines as a first officer; over the course of 34 years with the airline, she was promoted to captain and further distinguished herself by qualifying to fly numerous Boeing commercial jets and inspiring future generations to forge a legacy of their own; and

WHEREAS, Committed to creating opportunities for others, Captain Claiborne cofounded Sisters of the Skies to increase diversity within aviation professions; her achievements and enduring influence have been recognized with such prestigious awards as the 2024 Katherine Wright Trophy and induction into professional aerospace and aviation halls of fame; now, therefore, be it

PROCLAIMED, That the Senate of the State of Texas hereby commend Captain Theresa Claiborne on her outstanding contributions to American aviation and extend to her a warm welcome to the Lone Star State as she delivers the keynote address for the Frontiers of Flight Museum 2026 First in Flight Luncheon; and, be it further

PROCLAIMED, That a copy of this Proclamation be prepared for her as an expression of high regard from the Texas Senate.

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Member, Texas Senate

I hereby certify that the above Proclamation was adopted.

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Secretary of the Senate